

YOUR FIRST MOVE

Three tools for the life you're actually living.

- 01 The Story Separator** Separate facts from the stories your mind has built around them.
- 02 The Energy Snapshot** Map your actual capacity, not what you wish you had.
- 03 One True Thing** Find one honest anchor point to build your next move from.

You're not broken. You're unfinished.

Where You Are Right Now.

You are past the acute phase, or getting there, but something much harder is still unresolved. You are trying to figure out who you are now. Not who you were before. Not who the system has categorized you as. Who you actually are in this life, as you are now.

The people around you mean well. But they keep talking about recovery, resilience, and silver linings. And you are standing there thinking: none of those words are describing what I am actually experiencing.

What you are experiencing has a name. It is not a diagnosis. It is a gap. The gap between who you were and who you are becoming, and the complete absence of any framework for navigating it.

You are not behind. You are not broken. You are in a space that almost no program, therapist, or support group was designed to address. And you found this because some part of you knows: the tools need to be different now.

“The hardest part of disability isn't what it takes from you. It's that nobody hands you a map for the person who remains.”

You're not broken. You're unfinished.

I built this because I lived in the gap.

Shay Edmonds Founder, Reinvention Works™ · reinventionworksonline.com

After profound vision loss took not just my career but my identity, my relationships, and my entire sense of who I was in the world, I was medically managed, professionally categorized, and completely without a framework for the thing that actually mattered: who was I becoming?

Every tool I found assumed I had consistent energy. Every program assumed I was building back toward something recognizable. Every support group processed what was lost but didn't build what came next.

For years I searched for a framework that addressed identity after life-changing disruption. I never found one. So I built one.

These three tools are where it starts. Use them. Keep what lands. Reach out if something surprises you.

"I built what I needed."

This resource is peer-informed and educational: not clinical, not therapeutic. Built from lived experience, for people living it.

What Happens When You Ignore The Gap?

Most people don't ignore the gap on purpose. They just don't know it's there. They keep trying tools built for a different life, and wonder why nothing is working.

→ **They keep chasing their old identity.** Measuring every day against a version of themselves that no longer exists. The gap widens.

→ **They mistake confusion for failure.** Not knowing where to start looks like giving up. It isn't. It's the absence of a framework.

→ **They grieve the future they thought was guaranteed.** Most people aren't grieving what happened. They're grieving the future they assumed was coming.

The gap is not where people get stuck. The gap is where people stay stuck when nobody teaches them how to navigate it.

"You don't rebuild by becoming who you were. You rebuild by learning what you're actually capable of now."

Tool 1: The Story Separator

Most of what's making this hard isn't the disability itself. It's the story layered on top of it. Our minds build narratives around loss: fast, automatic, and often crueler than the facts warrant. This tool separates what is factually true from what the mind has added.

What Is Factually True *(what a doctor, court, or camera could confirm, no interpretation)*

What the Story Adds *(the interpretations, assumptions, and predictions)*

WHAT THIS REVEALS The facts column is almost always shorter, and more workable, than the story column. That gap is where the Reset begins.

WHY THIS WORKS The Story Separator reduces cognitive overload by separating observable fact from mental narrative. Psychologists recognize this as cognitive defusion, without the clinical language.

Take a breath here if you need one; Tool 2 is waiting whenever you're ready.

Tool 2: The Energy Snapshot

You cannot plan from a model that doesn't account for your actual capacity. Most life-planning tools assume consistent, predictable energy. When your energy is variable, by condition, by day, by hour, those tools fail before you start. This snapshot builds from where you actually are.

Today's Energy (1 to 10: 1 = empty, 10 = full. Don't adjust for what you think it should be)

My Best Window Today (the time when I have the most to give, even if it's 20 minutes)

What Drains Me Fastest Right Now (one specific thing, not a category)

What Restores Me (Even a Little) (one thing that returns something to me, however small)

What I'm Trying to Do With What I Have (one sentence, not a goal: what I'm actually doing today)

WHAT THIS REVEALS A single honest picture of your actual capacity: the only honest starting point for any real plan.

WHY THIS WORKS The Energy Snapshot aligns planning with real capacity instead of aspirational capacity. It solves the most common planning failure in variable-energy conditions.

Take a breath here if you need one; Tool 3 is waiting whenever you're ready.

Tool 3: One True Thing

Not a goal. Not a plan. One anchor point that is actually true about who you are right now. Identity after disability doesn't rebuild itself all at once. It starts with one honest observation: something you can stand on. That's what this tool finds.

Something I Value That Hasn't Changed *(a value or way of being still genuinely mine, even now)*

Something I'm Still Capable Of *(not what I used to do, something real I can do from exactly here)*

One True Thing About Who I'm Becoming *(an honest observation, not an aspiration)*

WHAT THIS REVEALS Identity doesn't rebuild from ambition. It rebuilds from what is actually true. This is the foundation everything else is built on.

WHY THIS WORKS One True Thing creates forward orientation from verified truth rather than aspiration. It moves identity reconstruction from abstract goal-setting to concrete, present-tense observation.

You've completed all three tools. Turn the page to see what comes next.

THE CONNECTION

You just previewed the three days.

Each tool in this guide mirrors one day of the 3-Day Reinvention Reset™.

TOOL 1 → DAY 1 Reality Check

The Story Separator is the starter version of Day 1's full framework: separating facts from stories, examining what's actually true, and replacing noise with clarity.

TOOL 2 → DAY 2 Energy Sovereignty

The Energy Snapshot is the entry point for Day 2's complete capacity framework: mapping your actual energy, reclaiming agency over how it's used, and building strategy from where you really are.

TOOL 3 → DAY 3 Recalibrated Action

One True Thing is the seed of Day 3's adaptive planning framework: building forward direction from your actual present position, not from a previous self or an expected recovery arc.

The Reset takes each of these tools and goes deeper: live, with Shay, over three consecutive days. Same framework. Full depth. Real forward movement.

WHAT COMES NEXT

The 3-Day Reinvention Reset™.

This guide gave you three tools. The Reset gives you the full framework: three live Zoom sessions with Shay over three consecutive days.

BEFORE DAY 1: YOUR DAY 0 SNAPSHOT If you join a cohort, you'll start with a short Day 0 Snapshot, a 5-minute baseline that measures where you are right now. You'll retake it after Day 3 so you can see exactly how far you've moved.

DAY 1 Reality Check. The complete Story Separator framework. Facts vs. stories, in depth, with Shay guiding.

DAY 2 Energy Sovereignty. The complete capacity framework. Map your actual energy and build strategy around what you genuinely have.

DAY 3 Recalibrated Action. An adaptive forward plan built from your actual current position, not a previous self.

Live via Zoom · Camera optional · Two hours per session · Three consecutive days

Offered through sponsoring organizations

Bring the Reset to your organization → reinventionworksonline.com

Cohort-based · Live on Zoom · Camera always optional

You will leave Day 3 with a real plan, not a list of goals.

On your own right now? Here is where to go next:

- Working with a VR counselor, independent living center or care team? Ask them about a sponsored seat.
- Talk it through with Shay, free, 15 minutes: reinventionworksonline.com/discovery-call
- See how the Reset works: reinventionworksonline.com/reset

This resource is educational: not clinical, not therapeutic.

The tools in this guide are designed for adults who are past the acute phase and navigating the identity, grief, and forward-direction questions that follow disability or significant health disruption. They are not designed for, and should not replace, professional mental health support, clinical care, or crisis intervention.

IF YOU ARE IN CRISIS Please reach out to the 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline (call or text 988) or your local emergency services.

About Shay Edmonds. Founder of Reinvention Works™ and Evocut Dynamics LLC. Built this work from lived disability experience following profound vision loss. Not a therapist or clinical provider. This is peer-informed, structured, educational programming for adults past the acute phase of their condition.

The three tools you just used are the beginning of a framework: not a quick fix, not inspiration, not a promise that it gets easier on a timeline. A real framework. Built for the life you are actually living.

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